

COMP7993 / COMP7300

Early Deliverable / Critical Review Assessment

Summary of details

Deliverable: Critical review of a substantial paper (or software tool) relevant to your project.

Assessment mode: Individual (even for group projects).

Deadline: **As stated on Moodle**

Submission: A single PDF file on the COMP7993/COMP7300 Moodle page.

Assessed by: Your supervisor.

Marking & Feedback: No numerical mark will be awarded, just formative feedback provided.

Description

This assessment is about writing (**individually**) a short document reporting what you have learned from reading a paper related to your final project. The goal of this exercise is to demonstrate that you are able to synthesise key points of a publication by performing its review.

Depending on the project, instead of a publication, it can be a software tool, a service, a white paper, or any artefact associated with the project.

The publication should be a substantial paper, either a conference or a journal paper. The publication should be relevant to the project to be undertaken, and should be chosen by the supervisor and the student together.

For group projects, the members of the group should have distinct assignments.

The criteria to be followed while preparing the paper review are reported in the next page, and closely follow Fong's guidelines presented in the video recording that introduces this assignment (available on Moodle). Fong's paper is also available on Moodle.

Philip W.L. Fong. 2009. Reading a computer science research paper. SIGCSE Bull. 41, 2 (June 2009), 138-140. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.1145/1595453.1595493>

The critical review should be structured like an essay. Do not try to answer directly the questions in Fong's paper since these are for guidance only.

The paper review should be within 2 pages long, formatted in single space with (minimum) 2cm margins (all sides). Font size should be either 11pt or 12pt.

Your submission should be a PDF file following the structure given below.

Structure of the critical review

Your critical review should be structured in three sections: **summary**, **critique**, and **synthesis**. The following description is adapted from Fong's paper.

Summary (1 page)

Give a brief summary of the work using your own words. This section demonstrates the understanding of the paper, and as such it should answer the four questions outlined in the "Comprehension" section of Fong's paper. The summary section should be structured as follows: (1) motivation, (2) contribution, (3) methodology and/or argument, and (4) conclusion. It is imperative that you use your own words to summarise the paper.

Critique (1/2 page)

Pick two to three points that would be interesting to argue with the authors of the paper. Use the questions outlined in the "Evaluation" of Fong's paper to help you come up with meaningful critiques. Do not repeat the Limitations section of the paper (if any). Do carefully articulate and substantiate your case. Do not just say, "I don't like this point." Instead, give technical reasons to substantiate your critiques.

Synthesis (1/2 page)

Propose one to two ways in which the research work can be further developed. Do not repeat the Future Work section of the paper (if any). Be original. Consult the list of questions in the "Synthesis" section of Fong's paper if you run out of ideas.

Submission details

Your submission should be in a PDF file and contain the following information:

On page 1:

- Personal information:
 - Student name and login.
 - Supervisor name.
 - MSc programme you are enrolled in.
- Full reference of the paper / piece of software you have reviewed.

On pages 2 and 3:

- Your paper / piece of software critical review.